

COMPREHENSIVE KNOWLEDGE BASE

Birth Certificate Services in Tanzania

Responsible Authority: Registration, Insolvency and Trusteeship Agency (RITA)

Primary Digital Portal: eRITA Portal — erita.rita.go.tz

Governing Legal Framework: Births and Deaths Registration Act, Cap. 108

1. General Overview of Birth Certificate Services

Birth registration is the formal process of recording the birth of a person in the national civil registration system. In Tanzania, birth registration provides an official legal record containing important information about an individual, including their name, date of birth, place of birth, sex, and details concerning their parents.

The Registration, Insolvency and Trusteeship Agency (RITA) is responsible for civil registration services, including the registration of births and the issuance of birth certificates. Many birth registration and certificate-related services can be accessed through the eRITA online portal, which allows applicants to submit applications, upload supporting documents, make payments, monitor application progress, and obtain information about their applications.

The principal legal framework identified in this knowledge base is the Births and Deaths Registration Act, Cap. 108.

2. Birth Registration Service Categories

The main birth certificate services covered by this knowledge base are: birth registration for children under 90 days; late registration for children between 90 days and 10 years; late registration for persons above 10 years including adults; conversion of old certificates; replacement of lost or damaged certificates; corrections and amendments; certificate verification; and registration of births occurring outside Tanzania.

2.1 Birth Registration for Children Under 90 Days

This is the standard birth registration category for newborn children whose births are reported and registered within 90 days of birth. The process is generally simpler because the birth is being registered within the normal registration period. Information supplied by the hospital, health facility, parents, or guardian is used to establish the child's birth record.

2.2 Late Birth Registration: 90 Days to 10 Years

Late registration applies when a child's birth was not registered during the normal initial registration period. This category covers children older than 90 days but below 10 years of age. Because the birth was not registered on time, additional evidence may be required to establish the identity of the child, the circumstances of the birth, and the relationship between the child and the parents.

2.3 Late Birth Registration Above 10 Years and Adults

This category applies to individuals who have never had their birth officially registered and who are above 10 years of age, including adults. Adult or long-delayed registration normally requires stronger identity evidence because the registration authority must establish that the information being submitted

corresponds to the actual individual. Applicants may therefore be required to provide multiple documents from different stages of their lives.

3. Old-to-New Birth Certificate Conversion

People who possess older manually issued or paper-based birth certificates may be required or permitted to convert the old certificate into a modern certificate format. The purpose is to update the record and produce a certificate compatible with modern verification mechanisms. Applicants should ensure that the information on supporting documents corresponds as closely as possible with the information recorded on the old certificate.

4. Replacement of a Lost or Damaged Birth Certificate

A person whose birth certificate has been lost, destroyed, or seriously damaged may apply for a replacement or duplicate certificate. This is different from registering a new birth because the applicant already has an existing birth record. The purpose is to obtain another official copy of that existing record.

5. Corrections and Amendments

Corrections and amendments are used when information appearing on an existing birth certificate is incorrect or needs to be legally changed. Examples include misspelled names, incorrect dates of birth, incorrect places of birth, or incorrect parental information. The applicant should provide documents that demonstrate the correct information. Major legal changes to identity information may require additional legal documentation.

6. Birth Certificate Verification

Birth certificate verification is the process of confirming whether a birth certificate or birth registration record is genuine and corresponds with official records. Verification may be required by government institutions, embassies, immigration authorities, educational institutions, employers, or other organizations requiring confirmation of identity documents.

7. Foreign Birth Registration

Foreign birth registration applies to children born outside Tanzania who may qualify for registration based on their Tanzanian parentage or citizenship circumstances. Such applications may involve Tanzanian diplomatic missions abroad and additional verification. Applicants should follow the specific instructions provided by the relevant embassy, high commission, or registration authority.

8. Document Requirements

The following requirements are reference requirements contained in this knowledge base. Actual requirements may depend on the applicant's circumstances and the current instructions of the responsible authority.

8.1 Newborn Under 90 Days

- Hospital Birth Notification from a recognized health facility.
- NIDA identification documents for the parents, where applicable.
- Valid passports where applicable.
- Clinic documentation for births occurring outside a hospital.
- Other supporting information requested during application.

8.2 Late Registration: 90 Days to 10 Years

- Hospital Birth Notification.
- Child clinic card.

- Introduction letter from the Ward Executive Officer (WEO) or Village Executive Officer (VEO).
- Parents' NIDA identification.
- Baptismal certificate, if available.
- School admission documentation, if available.
- Other evidence supporting the child's identity and birth circumstances.

8.3 Registration Above 10 Years / Adult

- Primary school certificate.
- Secondary school certificate.
- Sworn affidavit.
- WEO/VEO introduction letter.
- Parents' NIDA documents.
- Parents' death certificates if deceased.
- Childhood clinic or vaccination records.
- Voter identification.
- Driving licence.
- Passport where available.
- Passport-size photographs.

8.4 Old Certificate Conversion

- Original old birth certificate.
- Clear scanned copy of the certificate.
- NIDA identification and NIDA number.
- Educational or other official documents supporting the identity information.

8.5 Lost Certificate Replacement

- Police loss report.
- NIDA identification.
- Copy or photograph of the previous certificate if available.
- Existing registration information where available.

8.6 Corrections and Amendments

- Original birth certificate containing the error.
- Official documentation proving the correct information.
- NIDA card or other official identification.
- Academic certificates where relevant.
- Affidavit where applicable.
- Deed Poll or Court Order for certain major changes.

9. Fees and Tariffs

The reference tariff in this knowledge base lists the following fees. These amounts should be verified against the current official RITA/eRITA tariff before being presented as current fees.

Service	Reference Fee
Search / Record Lookup	TZS 3,000
Standard Registration	TZS 8,000
Late Registration Above 10 Years / Adult	TZS 20,000

Replacement	TZS 7,000
Verification	TZS 6,000
Correction / Amendment	TZS 13,000

10. Payment Process

After an application has been completed and validated, the system may generate a government payment control number. The applicant uses the control number to make the required payment. The reference knowledge base identifies mobile money services such as M-Pesa, Tigo Pesa, Airtel Money, HaloPesa, and AzamPesa, as well as commercial banks and authorized banking agents, as payment channels.

Applicants should retain their payment confirmation, control number, transaction/reference number, and application reference number. If payment is completed but the portal still shows an unpaid status, the applicant should first confirm the transaction and use the available reconciliation process rather than immediately making a duplicate payment.

11. eRITA Account Registration

An applicant begins by accessing the eRITA online platform. Account registration may require an active mobile phone number, email address, NIDA identification information, and other personal information required by the portal. Applicants should provide accurate information and ensure that their contact details remain accessible for application-related notifications.

12. Application Data Entry

After accessing the account, the applicant selects the appropriate birth certificate service and enters the required information.

12.1 Child Information

- Full name.
- Sex.
- Date of birth.
- Place of birth.
- Region.
- District.
- Ward.
- Health facility.
- Other birth-related information.

12.2 Parent Information

- Father's full legal name.
- Mother's full legal name.
- Parents' identification information.
- Citizenship information.
- Other parental details requested by the system.

13. Document Uploading

Supporting documents are uploaded electronically through the portal. The reference knowledge base identifies PDF and JPEG/JPG as common supported formats and specifies a maximum individual file size of 2 MB per document. Documents should be clear, complete, readable, correctly oriented, relevant to the application, and within the permitted file-size limit.

14. Application Review and Verification

Once the application and documents have been submitted, the registration authority reviews the information. The reviewing officer may compare information entered into the application, supporting documents, existing registration records, identity information, parent information, and other relevant evidence to determine whether the application satisfies registration requirements.

15. Possible Application Statuses

Submitted: The application has been successfully submitted and is awaiting processing.

Pending Review: The application is waiting for an officer to examine the information and supporting documentation.

Under Review: The application is actively being examined.

Queried: An issue requires clarification, additional information, or replacement documentation.

Approved: The application has passed the required review process.

Issued: The certificate has been produced or made available according to the relevant issuance process.

16. Printing and Certificate Collection

After approval, the birth certificate can proceed to issuance or printing. The certificate may contain security features designed to support authentication and verification. The applicant may be instructed to collect the certificate from the designated office and may need to present original identification, the application reference number, and other documents specified by the issuing office.

17. Special Case: Home Birth

A home birth occurs outside a recognized hospital or health facility. Because there may be no hospital birth notification, additional reporting procedures may apply. The parent or guardian may need to report the birth to the relevant Village Executive Officer or Ward Executive Officer, who may provide documentation supporting the birth registration application.

18. Special Case: Children Born Abroad

For a child born outside Tanzania to Tanzanian parent(s), registration may involve a Tanzanian diplomatic mission. Supporting evidence may include the foreign birth certificate or notification, Tanzanian parent passport, Tanzanian parent identification, and other documents required by the diplomatic mission. International cases may involve multiple authorities, so applicants should follow the specific instructions of the relevant mission or registration authority.

19. Special Case: Orphans and Abandoned Children

Where the parents of a child are unknown, deceased, or otherwise unavailable, the normal parental-documentation process may not be possible. Registration may involve a legal guardian, Social Welfare Officer, local government authority, or court. Supporting evidence may include a Social Welfare Assessment Report, guardianship documentation, Court Order where applicable, identification of the legal guardian, and available information about the child's identity and circumstances.

20. Special Case: Adopted Children

Adoption creates a special legal situation because the child's legal parental information may change as a result of the adoption process. Adoption-related registration may require formal legal documentation such as an Adoption Order and processing under applicable adoption and civil-registration procedures. Applicants should follow the specific adoption-related process rather than attempting to treat a legal adoption as an ordinary correction.

21. Refugees and Non-Citizens

Birth registration involving refugees or non-citizens may require procedures different from those applicable to Tanzanian citizens. The applicant may need to interact with relevant government authorities responsible for immigration, refugee affairs, or civil registration. Supporting documentation can include parent identification, refugee documentation where applicable, foreign passports, birth notification, local authority documentation, and other documents requested by the responsible authority.

22. Common Problem: Name Mismatch

Inconsistency between names appearing on different documents can cause an application to require additional verification. For example, a clinic card may contain a shorter or differently spelled name than a parent's identification document. The applicant may be asked to provide evidence explaining the discrepancy, such as an affidavit, WEO/VEO introduction letter, official identification, academic records, or other documents demonstrating that the names refer to the same individual.

23. Payment Reconciliation Problem

Sometimes an applicant successfully pays a government fee but the application portal continues to display an unpaid status. This can occur when payment information has not yet been correctly matched with the application. The applicant should confirm that money was deducted, retain the payment confirmation, check the control number and transaction/reference number, allow appropriate processing time, and use the portal's payment reconciliation functionality if available. If the problem remains unresolved, the applicant should contact the relevant official support channel.

24. Lost Application Reference Number

If an applicant forgets or loses an application reference number, the number may be recoverable through the applicant's online account by checking application history or previous applications. The applicant should look for the application reference, current status, payment information, and notifications. If the reference cannot be recovered through the account, the applicant should use the official support channels provided by RITA.

25. Application Delays

Applications may take longer than expected because of missing documentation, unclear documents, incorrect information, name mismatches, payment reconciliation problems, additional identity verification, manual review, high application volumes, or special circumstances requiring additional authority review. Applicants should monitor their application status and avoid submitting duplicate applications unless instructed to do so.

26. Document Quality Problems

A document may be rejected or queried if it is blurry, too dark, cropped, missing pages, upside down, illegible, expired where validity is required, or inconsistent with information entered in the application.

- Ensure all important information is visible.
- Use clear scans or photographs.
- Check that every page is included.
- Confirm that the document belongs to the applicant or relevant person.
- Check that names and dates are consistent with the application.

27. General Applicant Checklist

Personal Information

- Full names are correctly entered.
- Date of birth is correct.
- Place of birth is correct.
- Sex/gender is correctly selected.
- Parent information is correct.
- Citizenship information is correct.

Supporting Documents

- Required birth evidence is available.
- Identification documents are available.
- Additional documents for late registration are available.
- Documents are readable and complete.
- Uploaded files meet portal size and format requirements.

Payment

- Correct service has been selected.
- Correct control number has been generated.
- Payment has been completed.
- Payment confirmation has been retained.

After Submission

- Application reference number has been saved.
- Payment reference has been saved.
- Application status is monitored.
- Queries are responded to promptly.

- Original documents are kept safely for collection or verification.

28. Recommended Chatbot Decision Flow

For an AI or RAG chatbot, responses should be structured around the applicant's specific service category. The chatbot should first identify what the user wants, then determine the applicant's circumstances, provide only the relevant requirements, explain the process, and finally address likely problems or exceptions.

1. Identify the user's intention: newborn registration, late registration, adult registration, replacement, conversion, correction, verification, foreign birth, or another service.
2. Determine the applicant's circumstances, including age, previous registration status, place of birth, availability of parents, and supporting documents.
3. Identify the relevant requirements and provide a focused checklist.
4. Explain the application, document upload, payment, review, query, approval, and issuance stages.
5. Explain common problems relevant to the specific application.
6. Direct the applicant to official RITA/eRITA information whenever current fees, legal requirements, or procedural details need confirmation.

29. Chatbot Safety and Accuracy Rule

The chatbot should distinguish between official requirements and general guidance. Government fees, document requirements, office locations, processing times, portal procedures, and legal requirements can change. Therefore, the chatbot should not present potentially outdated information as permanently fixed. Reference figures in this knowledge base should be treated as a starting point and verified against current official RITA/eRITA information before users make payments or rely on a legal or administrative requirement.

30. Core Information Summary

Category	Key Information
Responsible Authority	RITA
Online Portal	eRITA
Legal Framework	Births and Deaths Registration Act, Cap. 108
Newborn Registration	Under 90 days
Late Registration	90 days–10 years
Adult/Late Registration	Above 10 years
Old Certificate	Conversion / upgrade
Lost Certificate	Replacement
Incorrect Information	Correction / amendment
Certificate Authenticity	Verification
Birth Outside Tanzania	Foreign birth registration
Common Evidence	Birth notification, clinic records, NIDA, local authority letters
Payment	Government control number and supported payment channels
Common Problems	Name mismatch, missing documents, unclear scans, payment reconciliation
Application Tracking	Applicant account / application history